Statement II: CORRECT—Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas has undertaken a series of reforms and new initiatives. Some of these include Hydrocarbon Exploration Licensing Policy (HELP)/ Open Acreage Licensing Policy (OALP), Discovered Small Field (DSF) Policy, Policy to Promote and Incentivise Enhanced Recovery Methods for Oil and Gas, Policy framework for exploration and exploitation of Unconventional Hydrocarbons under existing Production Sharing Contracts (PSCs), Coal Bed Methane contracts and Nomination fields, Policy for Relaxations.

36. Statement I: CORRECT—Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana (PMUY) was launched with the objective of providing LPG connections to five crore women belonging to the Below Poverty Line (BPL) families over a period of three years starting from 2016-17. The target was subsequently increased from 5 crore to 8 crore to be achieved by 2019-20. More than 7.189 crore LPG connections have been released under this scheme as of 31 March 2019. The original target of issuing five crore LPG connections was achieved by 3 August 2018, eight months in advance of the target. Statement II: CORRECT—Power sector in India has witnessed a paradigm shift over the years due to the constant efforts of Government to foster investment in the sector. As a result, India improved its ranking in the Energy Transition Index published by World Economic Forum (76th position).

    Fostering Effective Energy Transition, 2019 report of WEF states that “India, Indonesia and Bangladesh have made fast progress towards universal electrification due to strong political commitment, a stable policy regime, use of grid expansion, and decentralised generation sources, and a supportive environment for investment in infrastructure.”

37. Statement I: CORRECT—Housing is one of the fastest moving sectors in the country. According to Census 2011, 377.1 million Indians comprising 31.14% of the country’s population lived in urban areas, which are projected to grow more than 600 million by 2031. Urbanisation in India has become an important and irreversible process, and it is an important determinant of economic growth and poverty reduction.